

Directions for questions 1 to 4: The sentences given in the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

- ^{1.} Inhalers are more effective than tablets even when taken in smaller doses.
- ^{2.} Inhalers have replaced the more conventional tablets.
- ^{3.} The introduction of inhalers has revolutionized the treatment of common respiratory illnesses.
- ^{4.} Since a significant portion of the inhaled medication reaches the affected airways directly, they have a rapid onset of action and hence the relief comes faster.

Solution:

The paragraph talks about inhalers and contrasts them with tablets. Tablets have been the conventional way of treatment. But introduction of inhalers has revolutionized this field. Sentence 3 introduces the idea of the paragraph and so it forms the first sentence of the paragraph.

What is this revolution? The replacement of tablets by inhalers. This idea is seen in sentence 2 which follows 3 why has it replaced?

Because it is more effective – as seen in sentence 1 which follows sentence 2 How are they more effective? This is explained in sentence 4. Hence it follows sentence 1.

An : (3214)

Directions for questions 1 to 4: The sentences given in the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. The experts agree that something needs to be done to lessen the exam stress on students.
2. Huge brain-storming sessions are held to find a way to make the examination system stress-free.
3. This has to be done without lowering the quality of education.
4. Some of the leading institutions are against any policy that may lower their academic standards.

Your Answer: 2143 ✖

Correct Answer: 2134 ✔

Solution:

'Stress-free examination' is the topic discussed in the passage. Sentence 2 introduces the idea of sessions being held on the topic. Sentence 1 follows 2 as it talks about the experts' views on the issue. Sentence 3 follows 1 as sentence 1 says it has to lessen stress and 3 continues with the idea saying 'it has to be done without lowering the quality' of education. 4 concludes the paragraph by reiterating what is mentioned in 3.

Ans : (2134)

Directions for questions 1 to 4: The sentences given in the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. Plan your completion date, and when you arrive there with your goal accomplished, reward yourself.
2. A goal without a deadline is nothing more than a good intention.
3. Without a time frame, it is too easy to procrastinate, especially on the goals that take months or even years.
4. You must set a start time and a finish time for every goal that you set; you wouldn't be setting the goal if you had already done the things that you needed to do to achieve it.

Solution:

This four-sentence passage is about setting goals and what steps to take in order to attain them. The author points out various inputs that are essential to accomplishing these goals in one's life. The first sentence obviously is 2 because it begins with the indefinite article "a", which means that the author is introducing and talking about his subject for the first time. The author uses the noun "goal" or "goals" in all the remaining three sentences of the passage. In the second sentence 4 the author is prescribing the rule to accomplish the goal. He says one must set a start time and a finish time for every goal one sets. The first two sentences 2 and 4 are thematically united and promote the building up of the passage. The author, however, sounds a word of caution in the third sentence 3. In the second sentence 4 the author mentioned the start time and the finish time, in other words, the time-frame to realize one's goals. So in the third sentence he warns his readers that unless a time-frame is set, goals cannot be achieved. The author adds that if there's no time-frame, it's easy for one to procrastinate and fail to achieve the goals. Finally in the fourth sentence 1 the author urges his readers to set a completion time and accomplish the goals. The thematic and logical order of the four sentences is 2431.

Ans : (2431)

Directions for questions 1 to 4: The sentences given in the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. Bell Laboratories discovered that out of every 100 employees in a typical organization, approximately 5 of them are misplaced.
2. Business relationships play a major role in the security and productivity of every individual involved, as well as the growth and success of the company.
3. These figures do not hold true for all companies, but the concept is true.
4. I'm fascinated with the research done by Bell Laboratories, a high-tech company.

Your Answer: 4132 ✖

Correct Answer: 2413 ✔

Solution:

The paragraph is about the kind of success brought about by business relationships. The first sentence of the passage is the one that talks about the role of business relationships in individuals and companies. The first sentence, therefore, is 2. The first sentence is the introductory one, for it has spoken about the scope of business relationships. In the second sentence 4 the author says he is fascinated by the research carried out by Bell Laboratories about the role played by business relationships in an individual's life. Bell Laboratories collected some statistics or figures in the third sentence 1 about the percentage of people who become misfits in a company. The author, however, cautions his readers that the figures quoted by this company may not be true of every company. As in sentence 3. The logical sequence of the four sentences is 2413.

Ans : (2413)

Directions for questions 5 to 7: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences. From the pairs of words given below each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

Sor Juana was not a _____ as she lacked the powers of _____.

- ☐ a) psychiatrist . . . discretion
- ☐ b) stewardess . . . domestication
- ☐ c) protege . . . expostulation

☒ d) philosopher . . . abstraction (Your answer - ✓)

Directions for questions 5 to 7: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences. From the pairs of words given below each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

One of the unresolved and rather bitter _____ in evolutionary biology is whether or not evolutionary change is gradual or happens in sudden jumps that are separated by long periods of _____.

- ☐ a) contentions . . . inertia

☐ b) disputes . . . stasis (Correct Answer - ✓)

- ☐ c) struggles . . . inactivity

☒ d) contradictions . . . idleness (Your answer - ✗)

Solution:

In choice (A) 'contention' means 'an angry disagreement between people'. However the word 'inertia' refers to a lack of energy or ability to move or change. The usage of the word 'inertia' to signify inactivity in this context is inapt. Choice (B) is the correct choice. 'Disputes' means arguments or disagreements between people and 'stasis' is a situation in which there is no change or development. In choice (C), 'struggles' gives the meaning of a physical combat or contest and hence inapt.

The words 'contradiction' and 'idleness' given in choice (D) mean 'a lack of agreement between facts opinions etc.,' and 'a state of, not working hard or taking things too easy respectively. These two words do not help to bring out the correct meaning of the sentence to the surface.

Choices (B)

Directions for questions 5 to 7: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences. From the pairs of words given below each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

I am going to spend my time today, just _____ the people who played a role in my career, because I truly believe that I was blessed by a lot of people whose paths crossed mine as I went down the road in my _____.

☐ a) thinking . . . life

☐ b) thanking . . . career (Correct Answer - ✓)

☒ c) recalling . . . garden (Your answer - ✗)

☐ d) pleasing . . . driveway

Solution:

The sentence is about a person who suddenly decides on one particular day that , the entire day will be devoted to those who shaped his career. Thus the key word here is 'career' which is the second blank in the sentence. This is found in choice B. the first word of choice D is out of context making it a misfit. The first words of choices A, B and C are appropriate but we are already fixed with 'career' in choice B making it the right answer.

Choice (B)

Directions for questions 8 and 9: Each of the following questions presents 4 statements of which 3, when placed in appropriate order, would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick a statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. An apology is a good way to have the last word.
2. Sincerity is the most important ingredient in an expression of regret.
3. Apologizing is the most magical, healing and restorative gesture human beings can make.
4. Apologizing refers to a written or spoken expression of one's regret, remorse or sorrow for having insulted, failed, injured, pained or wronged another.

Your Answer: 2 

Solution:

The paragraph is about that difficult but wonderful thing called 'apology'. The right start would be choice 1 which defines apology. Choice 4 follows, describing the qualities of an apology. Choice 3 follows saying how this is a magical and healing gesture from a human being. Thus 1,4,3 is the logical order of the statements and choice 2 which discusses about 'sincerity' as the most important ingredient of an apology is a wee bit out of context making it the odd one out.

Ans : (2)

Directions for questions 8 and 9: Each of the following questions presents 4 statements of which 3, when placed in appropriate order, would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick a statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

- ^{1.} The world needs to abandon the idea of uninterrupted electricity supply.
- ^{2.} Food safety, crime rates, transport problems and the environmental cost of diesel generators all come to the fore during a blackout.
- ^{3.} Soaring electricity demand for air-conditioning, iPads and increasingly cars, combined with a growing population and inadequate investment in creaking power networks, is pushing the world towards frequent blackouts.
- ^{4.} China, Brazil and Italy have all had significant power failures in the past decade but these are just "dress rehearsals for the future" in which the lights will go out with increasing frequency and severity.

Solution:

Sentences 1, 3 and 4, in the order 3,4, and 1 make a contextually complete and coherent paragraph. 3 introduces the topic - soaring electricity demand is pushing the world towards frequent blackouts. 4 explains the idea by citing examples. 1 concludes the paragraph. Sentence 2 states the problems associated with blackouts – a point not directly related to the main idea of the paragraph.

Ans : (2)

1. But the regulator can also play a role in enhancing competition, among other things by getting its pricing right on spectrum.
2. High entry barriers typically reduce competitive pressures over time and favour incumbents.
3. In a technology industry such as telecom, it is very likely fundamental transformations can completely change the pecking order in a decade.
4. Over the last decade entry barriers in telecom have risen considerably, primarily in the form of capital requirement.
5. If regulatory standards can be enhanced even as market forces push the industry to adapt to new developments, the consumer will be the biggest beneficiary.

Solution:

Statement 4 can be considered to be the introductory sentence because it is in effect introducing the reader to entry barriers in telecom that have risen considerably, primarily in the form of capital requirement. This would then be followed by 2 which tells the reader about how high entry barriers which have risen in the field of telecom have reduced the pressure of competitiveness. Also the words "entry barriers" link this sentence to sentence 4. Statement 3 then speaks about how fundamental transformations can change the pecking order in just a matter of a decade in the telecom industry, this forms a direct link with sentence 2 which indicates how the pecking order is proportionate to the reduction of competitive pressures brought about by high entry barriers. Statement 1 then forms the concluding sentence because it connects with 3 in telling the reader how the regulator can also play a role in enhancing competition, Hence 4, 2, 3 and 1 (in that order) would form a meaningful paragraph. Option 5 cannot be part of the paragraph because it merely talks about how the consumer would be the biggest beneficiary if the regulatory standards are enhanced.

Ans : (5)

1. We have learnt to manufacture high quality drugs that are exported to the rest of the globe; an estimated 20% of generic drugs supplied globally are produced in India.
2. We built an extensive, sophisticated system to deliver multiple doses of polio vaccine to every child in this vast country, eradicating the disease.
3. Health outcomes can improve further and out of pocket expenses on health can reduce, to better protect citizens from financial risk.
4. Nationwide, our infant and maternal mortality rates have declined by more than one-third.
5. Over the last decade, India has made noteworthy strides in health.

Solution:

The introductory sentence will be 5 as it introduces the reader to the essence of the topic which talks about the advances that India has made in health. This will be succeeded by sentence 2 because it indicates how we have advanced in manufacturing high quality drugs, one field being the manufacture of polio vaccine and then developing a sophisticated system to deliver multiple doses of it to every child in this vast country thus eradicating the disease. The succeeding sentence will be 4 because it forms a connection with sentence 2 by speaking about how our health system has also helped to decrease our infant and maternal mortality rates. Sentence 1 will be the concluding sentence of the paragraph because it gives the reader an initial insight into how our country has advanced in the field of health, that is by having learnt to manufacture high quality drugs that are exported to the rest of the globe; an estimated 20% of generic drugs supplied globally are produced in India. Hence, sentences 5, 2, 4 and 1 (in the same order) form a meaningful paragraph. Statement 3 cannot be considered to be an integral part of the paragraph because it is tangential as it goes on to speak about how health outcomes can be further improved such that health care expenses can reduce. This has no bearing on the sentences that make up the paragraph and is therefore out of context.

Ans : (3)

1. With India ranking 143rd among 188 countries in a new health index based on health-related sustainable development goals, the government needs to fix the broken public healthcare system, focusing on preventive public health engineering.
2. With India lagging far behind several countries, including China, Syria, Iraq, etc., in a new healthcare-related sustainable development goals, there is an urgent need to fix the dilapidated public healthcare system.
3. With India's poor ranking in the new health index based on health-related sustainable development goals, there is a need to fix problems in the public healthcare system as sewage disposal, provision of potable water, control of vectors, etc.
4. It is a matter of concern that India ranks an abysmal 143rd among 188 countries in the new health index developed to assess each country's achievement on health-related sustainable development goals.

Directions for questions 12 and 13: Four alternative summaries are given below each text.

Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and indicate the number corresponding to it in the box provided below each question.

India ranks an abysmal 143rd among 188 countries in a new health index developed to assess each country's achievement on health-related sustainable development goals. The SDG index score is based on a scale of zero to 100. An overall score of 42 places India in the bottom quintile, way below China and even war-torn Syria and Iraq. This is appalling in itself, leave alone India's great power ambitions. The government must fix the broken public healthcare system. The focus should be on preventive public health engineering to dispose of sewage and solid waste, clean drinking water, vector control and vaccination, besides on low-cost healthcare.

1. With India ranking 143rd among 188 countries in a new health index based on health-related sustainable development goals, the government needs to fix the broken public healthcare system, focusing on preventive public health engineering.

2. With India lagging far behind several countries, including China, Syria, Iraq, etc., in a new healthcare-related sustainable development goals, there is an urgent need to fix the dilapidated public healthcare system.
3. With India's poor ranking in the new health index based on health-related sustainable development goals, there is a need to fix problems in the public healthcare system as sewage disposal, provision of potable water, control of vectors, etc.
4. It is a matter of concern that India ranks an abysmal 143rd among 188 countries in the new health index developed to assess each country's achievement on health-related sustainable development goals.

Solution:

The main points are:

- 1 India ranks 143rd among 188 countries in a new health index based on health-related sustainable development goals.
- 2 The government must fix the broken public healthcare system, focusing on preventive public health engineering.

Option 1 conveys the crux of the matter. India's ranking in the health index is important. This is not found in 2 and 3. Option 4 does not cover point 2.

Ans : (1)

As the US Presidential election results rolled in on November 9, 2016, it became apparent that America (and the world (would never be the same again. The American people overlooked all faults of the Republican nominee Donald Trump and elected him to the Oval Office in the belief that he will fix the nation's deep-rooted problems of inequity and injustice. And in doing so, they rebelled against the business interests and corruption they believed Hillary Clinton represented. Trump's victory was enabled by technology (everything from his use of social media to Clinton's email scandals to Russian hacking. But advancements in technology and how they reshape our economy may also prevent him from delivering some of the major promises that made him so popular during the campaign months.

1. Though Donald Trump emerged successful in the US presidential election of November 2016, technology is likely to derail his agenda.
2. Rebelling against the business interests and corruption that Hillary Clinton represented, the American people elected Donald Trump to the Oval office in the belief that he would fix the nation's problems of inequity and injustice.
3. Though Donald Trump's victory in the US presidential election of November 2016 was enabled by technology as well as the support of Americans who believed he would fix problems of inequity and injustice, the influence of technology may also prevent him from delivering some of the major promises.
4. Though technology enabled Donald Trump's victory, the advancements in technology and how they reshape our economy may also prevent him from delivering some of the major promises that made him so popular during the campaign months.

Solution:

The main points are:

- 1 In November 2016, Americans elected Donald Trump as the US President in the belief that he would fix problems of inequity and injustice.
 - 2 Though Trump's victory was enabled by technology, the influence of technology may also prevent him from delivering some of the major promises.
- Option 3 nicely expresses the essence of the passage. Option 1 is too brief. Point 2 is not found mentioned in option 2 while option 4 is incomplete.

Ans : (3)

Directions for questions 14 to 16: Each of the following questions have a paragraph from which the last sentence has been deleted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

Rapid urbanisation has converted fertile agriculture, forests and wetlands into concreted areas that are unable to retain rainwater or channel them into tributary streams that feed the Cauvery. Urbanisation demands concrete; concrete requires sand. In the districts surrounding the Cauvery, rampant sand mining has altered the natural topography of the river, eroding its banks, widening the river, and altering water flow patterns. Despite warnings from environmentalist groups and farmer coalitions, and interventions by the court, this practice continues unchecked. _____

- ☐ a) There needs to be a redesign of the farming system, keeping in mind in particular the water requirements of the crops planted after the onset of the south-west monsoon.
- ☐ b) Deforestation is widespread along the length and breadth of the river.
- ☐ c) It is no surprise that the wells that replenish farms across the basin are running dry or that desperate farmers are reduced to abandoning agriculture and renting their farms to sand contractors for sand storage.
- ☐ d) The large number of dams across the river contribute to a significant decrease in the river's capacity for water storage.

Solution:

The reasons for the decrease in the water in the Cauvery are many and one of them is urbanisation which depended on sand mining and which in turn destroyed the districts around the Cauvery and also the river bed. This thought process is continued further by telling what happened to the farmers that depended on the Cauvery in (C). They abandoned agriculture. The right answer is choice (C). The other choices, though closely related, talk about redesigning farming (A), deforestation (B) and dams (D) and hence they are not relevant here.

Choice (C)

It is hard to overstate the importance of good posture in projecting authority and an intention to be taken seriously. Good posture does not mean the exaggerated chest-out pose known in the military as standing at attention. It just means reaching your full height, using your muscles to straighten the S-curve in your spine rather than slouching. When you move, more deliberately and precisely to a specific spot. When you are finished moving, be still. Twitching, fidgeting or other visual static sends the signal that you're not in control.

- ☐ a) Being calm and confident creates space to be warm.
- ☒ b) Stillness demonstrates calm and control. (Correct Answer - ✓)
- ☐ c) Then your strength is received as a welcome reassurance.
- ☐ d) Right postures will soon create a positive feedback loop.

Solution:

The passage emphasizes the importance of good posture. The penultimate sentence says that twitching or fidgeting suggests that the person is not in control. Choice B concludes the passage saying that stillness demonstrates calm. Options A and C are unrelated points while D is a general comment about right postures. Choice (B)

So the life of the telegram is over. Given the major changes that have taken place in methods of communication during the past half century, this is no surprise. As communication systems have developed, and become ever more sophisticated, it would make no sense to continue using something that has been superseded by email, mobile phones, Facebook and Twitter. Nevertheless, for those of my generation, the telegram provokes many memories.

- ☐ a) So it would be difficult to make a strong case against the abolition of telegram.
- ☐ b) That the telegram has survived till recently seems incredible.
- ☒ c) So its departure is inevitably accompanied by a touch of nostalgia. (Your answer - ✓)
- ☐ d) So we regret for the passing of telegrams.

PAY

- ☐ a) She had to pay dearly for her misdemeanor.
- ☐ b) Unlike in the previous weeks, the employees received their pay on time

☒ c) Sara's hard work had paid off this time around. (Your answer - ✖)

☐ d) The government offers loans to farmers at nominal interest rates and allows them to pay up the loan over a period of three years. (Correct Answer - ✔)

Hide Correct Answer

Hide Solution

PREVIOUS

NEXT

Solution:

The usage of 'pay' is incorrect in choice D. To pay up means to pay all the money that you owe to somebody, especially when you do not want to or when, the payment is late. 'Pay back', meaning to repay, is the correct phrasal verb to be used here.

Choice (D)

DRAW

☐ a) He drew in his years of experience to solve the problem. (Correct Answer - ✔)

- ☐ b) The spectators were disappointed when the match ended in a draw.
- ☐ c) The advertisement played a crucial role in drawing people to the event.

☒ d) The circus turned out to be a big draw. (Your answer - ✖)

Hide Correct Answer

Hide Solution

PREVIOUS

NEXT

Solution:

The usage of the word draw in choice A is incorrect. The correct usage is 'drew on' which means to make use of some information, knowledge or experience from the past.

Choices (A)

Directions for questions 17 to 19: In each of the following questions, the word at the top is used in four different ways, A to D. Choose the option in which the usage of the word is INCORRECT or INAPPROPRIATE.

DUCK

- ☐ a) I managed to duck just in time to avoid the punch which was thrown at me.
- ☐ b) We had duck instead of turkey last Thanksgiving Day.
- ☐ c) The trouser which he wore was made up of duck.

☒ d) She took to cooking like a duck in water (Your answer - ✓)

Directions for question 20: Each of the following questions presents 4 statements of which 3, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick a statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below the question.

1. Two days later, the country's second largest private lender, HDFC Bank, questioned the sustainability of the mobile wallet business, which was at the vanguard of the shift to digital payments the days following demonetization.
2. Just a little over a fortnight after that will begin the new fiscal year – for which the government set a lofty target of 2500 crore transactions to be clocked on digital payment platforms like UPI, USSD and Aadhar Pay along with debit cards.
3. The comfort of much of that cold cash will be back, come March13, when all limits would be taken off, allowing people to withdraw as much as they want from banks.
4. Never underestimate the value of cold cash, and over a billion Indians would have sworn by that adage since early November when some 86 percent of currency was yanked out of circulation overnight.

Solution:

This passage comes in wake of the recent demonetization exercise in India, emphasizing the importance of physical cash. Choice 4 is the right beginning recalling the month of November 2016 when 86 percent of the currency was sucked out of circulation overnight. Choice 3 follows giving solace that the comfort of physical cash will be back on March 13. Choice 2 sums up, outlining the programmes thereafter with the government's ambitious targets for digital payments. Thus 4, 3 and 2 form a logical order of the statements while choice 1 is a solitary comment by one of the private banks on pay wallets making it the odd one out.

Ans : (1)